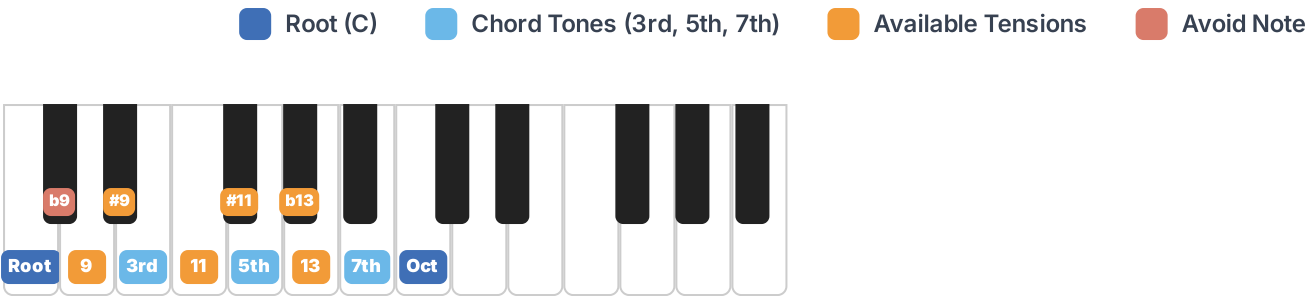


TENSIONS — THE FULL MAP

Every upper extension from root C — where they live on the keyboard and how to identify them instantly.



THE WHOLE-STEP RULE

WHOLE STEP above a chord tone = Available Tension ✓

HALF STEP above a chord tone = Avoid Note ✗

This single test tells you whether any note in the key is safe to add to any chord — instantly, without memorization.

THE RULE IN ACTION — TWO EXAMPLES

D above C (the root of Cmaj7)

Is D a whole step or half step above C?

Root 9 ✓ 3rd 5th

C → C# → D = WHOLE STEP above C → 9 is Available ✓

F above E (the 3rd of Cmaj7)

Is F a whole step or half step above E?

Root 3rd ✗ Avoid 5th

E → F = HALF STEP above E (3rd) → F (4th) is Avoid ✗